

Local SEO Checklist

A practical checklist for improving local search visibility, Google Business Profile presence, and location-based organic search performance.

1. Google Business Profile (GBP) Optimization

- ☐ Claim and verify all physical business location listings with Google.
- ☐ Select the most accurate primary business category, plus 3-5 relevant secondary categories.
- ☐ Upload high-resolution photos of the exterior, interior, staff, and products/services regularly.
- ☐ Publish weekly GBP Updates/Posts with distinct calls-to-action.
- ☐ Populate complete service menus and product catalogs with descriptions and pricing.

2. NAP (Name, Address, Phone) Consistency

- ☐ Verify identical NAP formatting across website footer, contact page, and GBP listing.
- ☐ Audit Tier-1 directories (Apple Maps, Bing Places, Yelp, YellowPages, BBB).
- ☐ Eliminate duplicate listings and incorrect legacy phone numbers or street addresses.

3. Location Pages & On-Page Signals

- ☐ Create dedicated localized landing pages for each key service area or physical branch.
- ☐ Embed responsive Google Maps and localized landmark/driving directions.
- ☐ Include city, neighborhood, and region keywords naturally in Title tags, H1s, URLs, and image ALT tags.
- ☐ Implement LocalBusiness Schema JSON-LD with geo coordinates, opening hours, and address.

4. Review Acquisition & Reputation Management

- ☐ Set up an automated post-service email/SMS review request workflow.
- ☐ Respond promptly to all reviews (positive and negative) within 24–48 hours.
- ☐ Incorporate relevant service and city keywords contextually into owner review responses.

5. Local Link Building & Citations

- ☐ Secure backlinks from local Chambers of Commerce and regional business directories.
- ☐ Sponsor local community events, charities, or sports clubs to earn localized domain backlinks.
- ☐ Publish locally relevant case studies, client spotlights, and area service guides.